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The Chief Editors
Journal of Official Statistics

Dear Editors,

Please consider the enclosed manuscript, “Anytime-valid monitoring of repeated survey estimates under questionnaire redesign: An application to the Business Trends and Outlook Survey”, for publication as a research article in the Journal of Official Statistics.

Statistical offices release short-period estimates from rolling surveys, and users read each release as it appears. Two problems follow that standard tools do not handle: error control under continuous inspection and optional stopping, and the discontinuities produced by questionnaire redesigns. The manuscript proposes a monitor for changes in the growth rate of a published series. Its null hypothesis is local linearity with unknown level and slope and a separate unknown level for each questionnaire regime, and a mixture e-process built on the residuals gives a closed-form test that is valid for all values of these nuisance parameters, using only published design-based standard errors. A simulation study based on the actual sampling errors of the survey reports where the method works and where it does not: it is less powerful than horizon-calibrated rules at small effects and fails for proportional redesign effects, misdated regimes and understated standard errors. An application to the 56 published waves of the U.S. Census Bureau’s Business Trends and Outlook Survey on business use of artificial intelligence reports the sensitivity of each declaration, including the effect of a single large drop and of inflated standard errors.

The paper suits the journal because it addresses a problem that statistical offices and users of their series face, the interpretation of frequent releases across redesigns, and its practical recommendation is simple: agencies should publish the regime label with each series. The manuscript is original, is not under consideration elsewhere, and has not been published. It has no footnotes or endnotes, is anonymised, and has a separate title page. The analysis data and code are provided so that every number can be reproduced. I have no conflicts of interest to declare and I have not suggested reviewers.

Yours sincerely,

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